# Physical Computing

## Syllabus & Overview

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# Description

- Module phycom

* https://www.fhnw.ch/de/studium/module/9880131

# Language

- Inputs in class are in German (DE)
- Course materials are in English (EN)
- Your contribution can be in DE or EN

# Credits

- 3 ECTS, 2 * 5 days, 8 + 1 hours a day
- Presence, active participation
- DIY-project, teams of 2
- Pass/fail, no grades

# Date

- Week 1, KW28, 12.07. – 16.07.2026
- Week 2, KW29, 19.07. – 23.07.2026

# Time

- 09:15 – 12:00, 3 hours in the morning
- 13:15 – 18:00, 5 hours in the afternoon
- 15 minute breaks, roughly once an hour

# Location

- Input, usually at the classroom, Room 4.515 (TBC)
- Making, usually at the makerspace, Room 4.125

# Presence

> Students are expected to be present for the entire two weeks

- The course consists of inputs and hands-on making sessions
- We will use specific tools available in a typical makerspace
- We count on you all to share your experience/perspective

# Absence

- Max 3 "joker" hours
- Have a good reason
- Ask us in advance
- Get confirmation
- Make up for it

# Conduct

> Be excellent to each other

- Actively participate
- Ask for / give help
- Respect boundaries

# Program Week 1

| Day | Input | Making |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Mon | Intro & DIY–Electronics | Soldering |
| Tue | Embedded Programming | Tinkering |
| Wed | Design & Ideation | Prototyping |
| Thu | Digital Fabrication in 2D | Laser–cutting |
| Fri | Digital Fabrication in 3D | 3D–printing |

# Program Week 2

| Day | Input | Making |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | PCB-Layout | Production |
| Tue | Documentation & Sharing | Exploring |
| Wed | DIY-Project Kick-off | Working |
| Thu | DIY-Project Inputs | Working |
| Fri | DIY-Project Inputs | Presenting |

# Program Specials

> At HTU, all participants are welcome

- Week 1, Mon, 07:45, welcome coffee
- Week 1, Fri, 12:00, free open lunch
- Week 2, Fri, 16 - 18:00, grill party

* https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/TODO

# Topics

0. Syllabus & Overview
1. DIY—Electronics & Soldering
2. Embedded Programming
3. Design, Ideation & Prototyping
4. Digital Fabrication in 2D
5. Digital Fabrication in 3D
6. PCB—Layout & Production
7. Documentation & Sharing
8. DIY—Project & Presentation

# Structure

Each topic follows this structure

- Motivation, why this is relevant, by example
- Basics, what you have to know, to get started
- Advanced, what brings you further, after basics
- Materials, what we provide to do hands-on tasks
- Tools, which tools you can use to get experience
- Skills, what you can learn by doing it yourself
- Resources, where you find more, quality info

# Materials

- Template repo, as a starting point
- Box of tools per team, to be returned
- Making materials, to be used responsibly

* https://github.com/tamberg/fhnw-phycom

# Audience

- This course can be attended by students from both, HSI and HTU
- Basic knowledge of either programming or electronics might help
- If you are not sure if this course is for you, consider contacting us

# Contact

- Contact us via MS Teams or email
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